

Sarah Daniel

Contact Information

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Education

University of California, Berkeley

Ph.D., Political Science

Expected: May 2027

M.A., Political Science

May 2023

Thesis: *“Trust and Identity: The Legacy Effects of Ujamaa Villagization”*

Chancellor’s Fellowship for Graduate Study Recipient

Subfields: Comparative Politics, Race and Ethnic Politics, Methodology

Committee: Leonardo Arriola (Co-Chair), Martha Wilfahrt (Co-Chair), Stephanie Zonszein, Scott Straus

University of California, Irvine

B.A., International Studies (Cum laude)

June 2019

Thesis: *“Trade, Race, and International Law: A Study of Tanzania’s Cashew Nut Sector”*

Education Abroad: Lund University, Sweden

June 2017

Working Papers

“Perceived Neighborhood Size and Civic Engagement: Evidence from Urban Kenya”. Draft available upon request.

“Protest or Partnership? How Nigerian Women’s Organizations Navigate Repression” with Mango Jane Angar, Leonardo R. Arriola, Matthew K. Gichohi, and Liv Tønnessen. Draft available upon request.

Work-in-Progress

“Boundaries of Representation: How Neighborhood Perceptions Shape Political Access”

“Boundaries of Coordination: How Shared Spatial Understandings Shape Collective Action”

“Which Context? How the Chosen Geographic Unit Affects Inference”

Invited Talks and Conferences

Midwest Political Science Association	2025, 2026
International Conference on Urban Affairs	2025, 2026
UC Berkeley–Stanford Africa Studies Graduate Conference	2026
UC Berkeley Center on the Politics of Development	2026
APSA Infrastructure and Built Environment Short Course	(Accepted) 2026
American Political Science Association	(Accepted) 2026
African Studies Association	(Accepted) 2025; 2026
UC Berkeley Center for African Studies Work-in-Progress Series	2025
National Conference of Black Political Scientists	2025
Urban Politics of the Global South	2024
African Studies Association	2023

Research and Professional Experience

Graduate Student Researcher, Political Science Department, UC Berkeley	2021–Present
Research Associate, Center on the Politics of Development, UC Berkeley	2021–Present
Research Consultant, UC Berkeley Research IT	2024–Present
Data Science and AI Fellow, UC Berkeley Data Lab	2025–2026
Research and Development Manager, TATU Project, Tanzania	2019–2020
Consular Intern, U.S. Department of State, U.S. Embassy Tanzania	2018

Software

WaySurvey	2026
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Teaching

Graduate Student Instructor, UC Berkeley	
Introduction to International Relations	Fall 2023, Fall 2025
Introduction to Comparative Politics	Spring 2024
Digital Humanities 100	Summer 2023
The Politics of Human Rights	Fall 2022

Affiliations and Service

Research Associate, Center on the Politics of Development, UC Berkeley	2021–Present
Undergraduate Mentor, Berkeley Connect	2026–2027
Research Mentor, Lumiere Education	2024–2025

Selected Fellowships and Awards

Berkeley Connect Fellowship (\$38,000)	2026–2027
James Goldgeier Fellowship for International Research (\$1,500)	2026
Andrew and Mary Thompson Rocca Fellowship (\$10,000 x2)	2024, 2025
Global, International and Area Studies Bendix-Sharlin Fellowship (\$1,000)	2025
John L. Simpson ABD Research Fellowship in International & Area Studies (\$11,000)	2024
Foreign Language and Area Studies Fellowship (\$2,500)	2022
Black Graduate Development Fellowship (\$750)	2021
Order of Merit, UC Irvine School of Social Sciences	2019
Chancellor's Award of Distinction, UC Irvine	2019
U.S. Department of State Benjamin Gilman Scholarship (\$5,000)	2017

Fieldwork and Languages

Fieldwork: Kenya (8 months, 2024–2026), Nigeria (3 months, 2023–2024), Tanzania (18 months, 2018–2021)
Software: R, STATA, MAXQDA, QGIS, Qualtrics, HTML
Languages: English (native), Spanish (intermediate), Kiswahili (intermediate)

References

Prof. Leonardo Arriola

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Prof. Stephanie Zonszein

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Prof. Martha Wilfahrt

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Prof. Scott Straus

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